



Diesel Mechanic

diesel-mechanic • 2 year program / apprenticeship

\$45K-\$65K / yr

THE TRADE

Repair and maintain the diesel engines and heavy equipment that keep trucks, fleets, and construction moving. Steady demand in transportation, flexible schedules, and a clear path from helper to OEM-certified (Cummins, Detroit) technician.

SALARY & TRAINING

JOURNEYMAN BAND (SITE FIGURE — SAME AS QUIZ RESULT & TRADES PAGE)

\$45K-\$65K

Site band (trades page / quiz) • 2-yr programs • no dedicated salary post yet — assumed

THE PATH: FROM RESEARCH TO HIRED

01 RESEARCH Compare training routes, union vs non-union, and local demand

02 TRAIN Trade school / pre-apprenticeship — start with OSHA 10

03 HANDS-ON Apprentice years: log hours, earn raises to 80-90% of scale

04 CERTIFIED Pass the journeyman or industry certification exam

05 HIRED Journey-level pay — specialize, stack certs, own the shop

Every apprentice track pays from day one — typical start is 40-50% of journey scale with scheduled raises every year. Each step above is fully mapped on the TradeLift Getting Started guide and the site's resources page.



REQUIRED CERTIFICATIONS & CREDENTIALS

ASE Medium/Heavy Truck certifications (T1, T8)

YOUR FIRST 12 WEEKS — THE ACTION CHECKLIST

- ☐ Take the TradeLift quiz to confirm fit
- ☐ Call all local fleets about helper roles
- ☐ Earn OSHA 10 or shop-safety basics
- ☐ Draft a one-page trade resume
- ☐ Buy metric sockets + a torque wrench
- ☐ Tour a truck or equipment dealership
- ☐ Practice a basic PMI on a friend's rig
- ☐ Start ASE T-series study prep
- ☐ Apply to OEM and diesel tech programs
- ☐ Apply to 2 dealer apprenticeships
- ☐ Keep a repair log with photos
- ☐ Shadow a diesel tech for a day

Full career steps, certifications, and tool guides: <https://tradelift.surge.sh/getting-started.html>